



Designing Metrics: KRIs, KCIs & Executive Dashboards

DESIGNING METRICS: KRIS, KCIS & EXECUTIVE DASHBOARDS



GRC GATE TRAINING

Why Metrics and Dashboards Matter

Metrics enable oversight and align strategy with operations

- Dashboards translate complex info into actionable insights

Organizations face turbulent markets and shifting regulations

- Like a captain, they need robust metrics and indicators

Dashboards reveal where risks, controls, or strategies falter

- Analogous to dials for a ship's critical systems

Effective metrics help steer through uncertainty and disruption

- Data guides decision-making, not just intuition





Key Concepts: KRIs, KCIs, and Dashboards

Key Risk Indicators provide early warnings on potential threats

- Shine light on risks before escalation occurs

Key Control Indicators measure operational effectiveness of controls

- Help prevent or detect identified risks

Executive dashboards synthesize complex data into decision guides

- Use clear visuals and narratives for leaders

Hospital Analogy: Metrics in Practice

CMO uses dashboards to monitor safety and outcomes

- Relies on infection rates (KRI) and hand hygiene (KCI)

Dashboard highlights trends and prompts questions

- Not just numbers, but warns of issues in real-time

Data story aids resource allocation and protocol changes

- Enables swift, preemptive interventions

Balanced dashboard supports critical decision-making

- Focus on patient safety and process gaps



Key Risk Indicators (KRIs): Purpose and Examples

KRIs signal shifts in the organization's risk profile

- Serve as early warnings, not merely statistics

Examples include failed transactions or safety incidents

- Indicate instability or process weaknesses

Value lies in predictive, actionable information

- Leaders act before full risk materializes

Timely KRIs can avert minor issues from becoming crises

- Provides intervention opportunities



Selecting and Validating Effective KRIs

Requires understanding objectives, risk appetite, and context

- Not all indicators have equal relevance or impact

KRIs must be relevant, quantifiable, and sensitive to changes

- Avoid metrics with weak risk correlation

Example: Port congestion rate better indicator than fuel price volatility

- Real warning aligns with actual risk exposure

Regular validation keeps KRIs aligned as risks evolve

- Critical thinking and data analysis required



Key Control Indicators (KCIs): Measuring Defense Health

KCIs assess effectiveness of controls mitigating specific risks

- Similar to routine maintenance checks for organizations

Examples: checklist completion and staff training in hospitals

- Percentage or frequency indicates control health

Info security KCIs track system patches and access reviews

- Monitors controls for critical systems

KCIs show whether defenses are functioning as designed

- Links control actions to risk reduction

Designing KCIs for Effectiveness, Not Just Activity

KCIs must connect to risk and control frameworks clearly

- Should drive meaningful organizational action

Pitfall: Focusing on activity over true effectiveness

- E.g., mandatory training completion without knowledge retention

Combine quantitative and qualitative KCIs for full impact

- Use phishing simulations, assessments beyond raw completion data

Ensure KCIs measure intended control outcomes, not just processes

- Avoid false sense of security from surface metrics



The Role of Executive Dashboards

Dashboards integrate KRIs and KCIs into actionable visuals

- Act as the organizational cockpit for timely decisions

Highlight trends, exceptions, and use visual cues effectively

- Avoid overwhelming users with excessive data

Real-time summaries align risks, controls, and strategy

- E.g., show incident attempts, patching compliance, trust KPIs

Make risk-control gaps visible to prompt immediate action

- Enable reassessment of posture and resource allocation



Holistic Dashboard Example: Financial Industry

Bank dashboard integrates KRIs, KCIs, and KPIs for growth

- Includes default rates, documentation checks, business indicators

Detects rising risks and control breakdowns in real-time

- Correlates indicators to reveal root causes efficiently

Enables targeted audits and proactive process adjustments

- Intervention before losses or issues escalate

Drives better outcomes for organization and stakeholders

- Supports customers and regulatory compliance



Challenges in Dashboard Design and Use

Data overload distracts from critical insights and weakens trust

- Too many metrics obscure trends needing attention

Timeliness and accuracy issues can erode confidence

- Outdated data leads to poor decisions

Automation and quality governance reduce risks in metric reporting

- Invest in pipelines and clear metric definitions

Engage stakeholders so dashboards match priorities and strategy

- Content should support executive needs and organizational story

Human Factors and Dashboard Impact

Metrics can unintentionally promote blame or negative behaviors

- Transparency without support may foster defensiveness

Dashboards must balance openness with encouragement

- Frame metrics as tools for growth, not punishment

Effective dashboards cultivate learning and improvement culture

- Leadership and design shape dashboard influence

Commitment to continuous improvement enhances metric value

- Empathy and thoughtful design are crucial



Reflection Questions on Metrics and Dashboards

How do risk, control, and strategy interact in your environment?

- Identify if current metrics highlight necessary areas for action

Recall a time a risk emerged without warning

- Assess if early warnings or control gaps existed

Imagine a more meaningful dashboard for your team

- Visualize its impact on resilience and performance

Consider how metric choices affect organizational outcomes

- Evaluate if metrics go beyond box-ticking



The Transformative Power of Metrics

Metrics shape conversations and influence organizational culture

- Go beyond compliance to support vision and strategy

Thoughtful KRIs, KCIs, and dashboards foster resilience

- Prevent failure and encourage agility, learning, and growth

Oversight shifts from reactive to proactive management

- Metrics enable value creation, not just risk avoidance

Well-designed indicators drive alignment and improvement

- Link daily operations to long-term goals



Applying Metrics and Dashboards for Resilience

KRIs and KCIs underpin threat anticipation and defense maintenance

- Integration is crucial for insight and strategy alignment

Dashboards turn data into actionable executive insights

- Bridge control health and strategic direction

Selection and quality of indicators present challenges

- Relevance, data accuracy, and balanced reporting are vital

Metrics drive performance and positive human experience

- Impact both organization and its people

Empower Teams with Actionable Metrics and Dashboards

Choose metrics that empower rather than merely inform teams

- Metrics should inspire action and learning

Design dashboards that drive improvement and engagement

- Focus on both information and motivation

Your skill in metric design fuels professional growth

- Essential for building organizational resilience

Crafting these tools enables lasting impact and oversight

- Foundational to strong frameworks and leadership

